

Skill Ramp-Up Plan – Part 2 (HTML & CSS foundations to NeoXam Impress clone)

Block 0 – Opening & Navigation (DevTools basics)

Skills

- I can open DevTools quickly with F12 or Ctrl+Shift+I / Cmd+Opt+I.
- I can select an element on the page with the “Inspect” icon (Ctrl+Shift+C).
- I can inspect and live-edit HTML and CSS inside the Elements panel.
- I can read computed styles to understand margins, padding, colors, and fonts.
- I can enable/disable CSS rules or add new ones directly.
- I can visualize the box model (margin, padding, border) graphically.
- I can use rulers, flexbox and grid overlays to see positioning and layout zones.
- I can simulate :hover or :active states.
- I can use the Console to read JavaScript errors and warnings.
- I can run small snippets (e.g. `document.querySelector`) and check variables or events.

Resources

- [Chrome DevTools overview](#)
- [Inspect CSS Grid & Flexbox](#)
- [DevTools Console](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Open DevTools on a webpage, inspect a DOM element, toggle a CSS property on and off, visualize the box model, activate a flexbox overlay, and log a message in the console.

Block 1 – Discover essential HTML tags

Skills

- I can structure a web page using `<html>` , `<head>` , and `<body>` .
- I can add titles and paragraphs with `<h1>` – `<h6>` and `<p>` .
- I can create links `<a>` and display images `<img>` .
- I can build unordered and ordered lists with `<ul>` , `<ol>` , `<li>` .

- I can group content with `<div>` and `<section>`.
- I can apply semantic tags like `<header>`, `<footer>`, `<main>`, `<article>`.
- I can create tables with `<table>`, `<thead>`, `<tbody>`, `<tr>`, `<th>`, `<td>`.
- I can create forms with `<form>`, `<label>`, `<input>`, `<textarea>`, `<button>`.

Resources

- [HTML elements reference](#)
- [HTML tables basics](#)
- [HTML forms](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Build a full HTML page with a header, a main section, and a footer. Inside main include a paragraph, an image, a list, a simple form, and a 2×3 table with headers.

```
+-----HEADER-----+
| <h1> My Title </h1> |
+-----MAIN-----+
| [Paragraph text]    |
| [Image]             |
| [Unordered list]    |
| [Simple form fields]|
| [Table 2×3]         |
+-----FOOTER-----+
| <a> Link </a>       |
+-----+
```

Block 2 – Basic CSS: selectors and properties

Skills

- I can link an external CSS file to my HTML.
- I can target elements by tag, class, and id.
- I can set colors, fonts, and backgrounds with CSS properties.
- I can adjust margins, padding, and borders to control spacing.

Resources

- [CSS first steps](#)
- [CSS selectors intro](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Style the page from Block 1 so the main heading has a distinct color, the header has a background color, and the main paragraph has visible padding and a border.

```
HEADER (background color)
  h1 (different color)
MAIN
  Paragraph (with padding and border)
FOOTER
```

Block 3 – Advanced CSS selectors

Skills

- I can use direct child selectors `>` and descendant selectors.
- I can apply `:first-child`, `:last-child`, `:nth-child()`, `:nth-of-type()` to target specific items.
- I can exclude items with `:not()` and group selectors with `,`.
- I can combine selectors to style only the elements I need.

Resources

- [CSS selectors](#)
- [How nth-child works](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Create a list of at least five items: style the first item blue, all even items green, and only the paragraphs directly inside a `<section>` (excluding those with `.skip`) bold.

```
<section>
  p (bold)
  <ul>
    1st item (blue)
    2nd item (green)
    3rd item (normal)
    4th item (green)
  </ul>
</section>
```

Block 4 – Margin vs Padding

Skills

- I can explain the difference between margin (external space) and padding (internal space).
- I can apply margin to separate elements.
- I can apply padding to create inner spacing.
- I can inspect spacing using DevTools.

Resources

- [Box model](#)
- [CSS margin](#)
- [CSS padding](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Create two boxes side by side: one with margin to push it away from other elements, one with padding so its text is indented from the border.

```
+-----+ +-----+
| BOX A  | | BOX B  |
| (margin)| | padding |
|outside | | inside  |
+-----+ +-----+
```

Block 5 – Positioning and display

Skills

- I can position elements using `relative`, `absolute`, `fixed`, and `sticky`.
- I can control stacking order with `z-index`.
- I can change the display property (`block`, `inline-block`, `flex`, `grid`, `none`).

Resources

- [CSS position](#)
- [Stacking context](#)
- [Display](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Add a banner at the top of the page that stays fixed while scrolling. Ensure all other content appears below without overlapping.

```
+-----FIXED BANNER-----+
| stays visible at top      |
+-----+
(scrollable content below)
```

Block 6 – Typography and colors

Skills

- I can adjust font-family, font-size, and line-height for text readability.
- I can set colors and background-colors to create contrast.
- I can align text horizontally and adjust its weight.

Resources

- [CSS fonts](#)
- [line-height](#)
- [CSS color values](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Apply a custom font and line-height to the main section, center the main heading, and give the footer a contrasting background.

Diagram

```
HEADER (centered h1)
MAIN (custom font, spacing)
FOOTER (contrasting background)
```

Block 7 – Pseudo-classes and pseudo-elements

Skills

- I can create hover, focus, and active states for interactive elements.
- I can add decorative content before or after elements using pseudo-elements.

Resources

- [Pseudo-classes](#)

- [Pseudo-elements](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Create a button that changes background color on hover, shows a clear outline on focus, and displays an icon or symbol before its text using a pseudo-element.

```
[ ★ Click me ] (normal)
[★ Click me] (hover = different background)
focus outline visible
```

Block 8 – CSS variables and inheritance

Skills

- I can define CSS custom properties and reuse them across the stylesheet.
- I can explain how CSS inheritance and the cascade affect my styles.

Resources

- [Using CSS custom properties](#)
- [Cascade and inheritance](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Define a global color variable and use it for the main heading and the footer text. Change the variable once and verify both areas update automatically.

```
Color variable -> affects:
H1 text color
Footer text color
```

Block 9 – Transitions and transforms

Skills

- I can animate property changes smoothly using `transition`.
- I can transform elements with scale, rotate, or translate.

Resources

- [CSS transitions](#)
- [CSS transform](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Enhance the button from Block 7 so it smoothly enlarges when hovered, creating a clear animated effect.

```
[ Click me ] -> hover -> [ Click me ] (larger)
```

Block 10 – Responsive design and media queries

Skills

- I can create layouts that adapt to different screen sizes using media queries.
- I can use flexible units like %, em, rem, vh, and vw.

Resources

- [Responsive design](#)
- [Media queries](#)
- [CSS units](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Create a two-column layout for desktop that automatically stacks into a single column when the viewport width is below 600 px.

Diagram

DESKTOP $\geq 600\text{px}$:

```
+-----+ +-----+
| Left col | | Right col |
+-----+ +-----+
```

MOBILE $< 600\text{px}$:

```
+-----+
| Left col      |
+-----+
| Right col     |
+-----+
```

Block 11 – Flexbox for layout

Skills

- I can define a flex container and arrange elements horizontally or vertically.
- I can align items using justify-content and align-items.
- I can make layouts flexible with flex-grow, flex-shrink, and flex-wrap.

Resources

- [Flexbox on MDN](#)
- [Flexbox Froggy game](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Build a section with three equally sized boxes arranged horizontally using Flexbox. On mobile screens, stack them vertically.

Diagram

DESKTOP:

```
+-----+ +-----+ +-----+
|Box1|  |Box2|  |Box3|
+-----+ +-----+ +-----+
```

MOBILE:

```
+-----+
|Box1|
+-----+
|Box2|
+-----+
|Box3|
+-----+
```

Block 12 – CSS Grid

Skills

- I can define a grid container with columns and rows.
- I can use grid-template-columns and gap to control layout.

Resources

- [CSS Grid on MDN](#)

- [Grid Garden game](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

Create a grid of six boxes arranged in three equal columns with uniform gaps.

Diagram

```
+-----+ +-----+ +-----+
| B1   | | B2   | | B3   |
+-----+ +-----+ +-----+
| B4   | | B5   | | B6   |
+-----+ +-----+ +-----+
```

Block 13 – Reproduce part of NeoXam Impress page

Skills

- I can analyze an existing page layout to identify sections.
- I can recreate layouts using HTML structure and CSS.
- I can style with Flexbox and Grid and make it responsive.

Resources

- [NeoXam Impress reference](#)
- [Flexbox & Grid docs](#)
- [Responsive design on MDN](#)

Definition of Done (Exercise)

With your lead, choose a specific section of NeoXam Impress (e.g. header + hero). Recreate it with:

- Fixed navigation bar at top (logo left, links right).
- Hero section (heading, subheading, button left + image right).
- Features section (three columns with icon + heading + text).
- Footer (dark background, two columns).

Ensure it's responsive: hero stacks, features stack on mobile.

```
+-----+
| [Logo]                               [Link] [Link] [Link] |
| (Fixed nav bar)                               |
+-----+
```

+-----+			+-----+			
Heading + Subtext			[Image placeholder]			
[CTA Button]						
+-----+			+-----+			
+-----+						
+-----+			+-----+			
Icon+H2			Icon+H2			(three features)
+-----+			+-----+			
+-----+						
[Footer Left Text]			[Privacy][Terms]			
(Dark background)						
+-----+						